W. Matthew Alampay Davis

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Department of Economics
Columbia University
New York, NY 10027

Education

Columbia University · Graduate School of Arts and Sciences
Ph.D Economics (2025, expected)

University of Oxford · Nuffield College
M.Phil Economics (2019)

New York University · Stern School of Business
B.S. Business & Political Economy (2015)

Research

Development economics · Environmental economics · Political economy

Dissertation: Essays on development, the environment, and inequality
Climate inequality (Job Market Paper)
Gendered violence and cultural disruption (*with* Tanushree Goyal)
Political transition under environmental change
The political economy of descriptive and substantive representations

Large potential reduction in economic damages under UN mitigation targets, Nature
with Marshall Burke, Noah S. Diffenbaugh (2018)

Combining satellite imagery and machine learning to predict poverty, Science
with Neal Jean, Marshall Burke, Michael Xie, David B. Lobell, Stefano Ermon (2016)

Professional

Teaching at Columbia University (nine semesters, 2020–2024)
Consultant to all undergraduate and graduate thesis writers and research assistants
ECON-4999 - Senior honors thesis workshops (design and instruction)
ECON-3412 - Introduction to econometrics (TA)
ECON-3211 - Intermediate microeconomics (TA)
ECON-2257 - The global economy (TA)

Research
Referee: Journal of Development Economics
Associate: University of Oxford, Climate Econometrics Group (2017–2019)
supervised by David F. Hendry, Elizabeth Baldwin
Pre-doctoral scholar: Stanford University, Dept. of Earth System Science (2015–2017)
supervised by Marshall Burke, David Lobell

Honors

Program for Economic Research Summer Fellowship (2024)
Columbia economics department award supporting summer research activities

Wueller Fourth-Year Pre-Dissertation Award (2023)
Columbia economics department runner-up best dissertation proposal

UC Berkeley and Sloan Foundation Diversity Fellowship (2022)
Awarded to five doctoral students in environmental and energy economics

Columbia GSAS Dean's Fellowship and Dissertation Fellowship (2019)
Full tuition and living stipend for up to six years of graduate study at Columbia

Oxford M.Phil economics top-scoring thesis (2019)
Department's first 'exceptional' (mark of 80+) thesis in at least four years

Nuffield College–Department of Economics Joint Studentship (2017)
Full tuition and living stipend for up to four years of graduate study at Oxford

Background

Philippines (nationality) · Indonesia (13 years) · Vietnam (3 years)